

Staying alive

So many water creatures feed on fish, that they all have to be careful – or very cunning – to make sure they don't get eaten.

Porcupine fish

The flat porcupine fish usually looks like any other fish in the tropical seas.

Ballooning up

The porcupine fish seems harmless until it is alarmed. It then gulps in water to blow itself up, which pushes out its spines, making it impossible to swallow.

Safety in numbers

Fish that live in shoals, or groups, are far safer in large numbers. They all keep an eye out for enemies and will sometimes split into two groups to confuse them.



Camouflage

Many fish use camouflage to hide. Flatfish, such as this plaice, bury themselves on the sea floor, then change their colour to blend into the sand and the stones.